

LEGAL PROCEEDINGS ANALYSIS

*Comprehensive Review of Criminal and Civil Cases
Involving Donald J. Trump*

Document Type: Legal Research Compilation

Date: February 2025

Classification: Public Records Analysis

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1. Introduction and Methodology

Important Notice: This document compiles publicly available information regarding legal proceedings involving Donald J. Trump. It is intended for informational and research purposes only. This compilation does not constitute legal advice, nor does it represent an official government document. All information is sourced from publicly available court records, news reports, and official government filings. The presentation of cases herein does not imply judgment on the guilt or innocence of any party.

This analysis examines the legal proceedings involving Donald J. Trump, the 45th and 47th President of the United States, from 2016 to the present. The document provides a factual compilation of criminal cases, civil litigation, and regulatory actions based on publicly available court records and official sources.

The methodology employed in this analysis includes:

- Review of official court filings and docket entries
- Analysis of judicial opinions and orders
- Examination of publicly available indictment documents
- Review of settlement agreements and judgments
- Cross-reference with multiple verified news sources

2. Executive Summary

Donald J. Trump has been the subject of numerous legal proceedings spanning criminal, civil, and regulatory domains. As of February 2025, the status of major proceedings is as follows:

Case Category	Number of Cases	Status Overview
Criminal Convictions	1	34 felony counts - unconditional discharge
Criminal Cases Dismissed	3	Dismissed (DOJ policy/venue)

3. Criminal Proceedings

Major Civil Judgments	2	\$83.3M (affirmed); \$464M (vacated on appeal)
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Settlements	2	Trump University (\$25M); Foundation Dissolution
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3. Criminal Proceedings

3.1 Manhattan District Attorney - Hush Money Case

People v. Donald J. Trump

Court: New York Supreme Court, Manhattan

Judge: Juan Merchan

Indictment Date: March 30, 2023

Verdict Date: May 30, 2024

Charges: 34 felony counts of falsifying business records in the first degree (N.Y. Penal Law § 175.10)

Prosecution Theory: The Manhattan District Attorney alleged that Trump engaged in a scheme to influence the 2016 presidential election through hush money payments to adult film actress Stormy Daniels. The payments were allegedly made by Michael Cohen, Trump's former attorney, and reimbursed through the Trump Organization with falsified business records characterizing them as legal expenses.

Key Allegations:

- "Catch and kill" arrangement with AMI/National Enquirer to suppress negative stories
- \$130,000 payment to Stormy Daniels in October 2016
- \$150,000 payment to Karen McDougal facilitated by AMI
- Reimbursement to Michael Cohen structured as 12 monthly payments of \$35,000
- Business records falsely labeled as "legal expenses"

Verdict: On May 30, 2024, the jury found Trump guilty on all 34 counts. This marked the first time in U.S. history that a former president was convicted of criminal charges.

Sentencing: On January 10, 2025, Judge Merchan sentenced Trump to an **unconditional discharge** - meaning no prison time, fines, or probation. The judge stated this was the "only lawful sentence" to protect "the office of the president... not the occupant of the office."

Current Status: **On Appeal** - Trump has filed an appeal with New York's intermediate appellate court arguing the verdict should be overturned.

Applicable Law: N.Y. Penal Law § 175.10 (Falsifying Business Records in the First Degree) - Class E felony; requires intent to defraud and intent to commit another crime or conceal another crime.

3.2 Federal Election Interference Case (Dismissed)

United States v. Donald J. Trump

Court: U.S. District Court, District of Columbia

Judge: Tanya Chutkan

Special Counsel: Jack Smith

Indictment Date: August 1, 2023

Charges: Four federal felony charges:

- Conspiracy to Defraud the United States (18 U.S.C. § 371)
- Obstruction of an Official Proceeding (18 U.S.C. § 1512(c))
- Conspiracy to Obstruct an Official Proceeding (18 U.S.C. § 1512(k))
- Conspiracy Against Rights (18 U.S.C. § 241)

Prosecution Theory: The special counsel alleged Trump engaged in a "criminal scheme" to overturn the 2020 presidential election results, including efforts to create fake elector slates, pressure Vice President Pence to reject certified electors, and obstruct the January 6, 2021 congressional certification.

Key Allegations:

- Organization of fraudulent elector slates in seven states
- Pressure campaign against state election officials
- Pressure on Vice President Pence to reject electoral votes
- Exploitation of the January 6 Capitol violence

Disposition: **Dismissed Without Prejudice** - On November 25, 2024, Judge Chutkan dismissed the case following the Justice Department's request, citing the long-standing DOJ policy prohibiting prosecution of a sitting president.

Special Counsel Report: Released January 14, 2025, Smith's final report stated that "but for Mr. Trump's election and imminent return to the Presidency," the evidence would have led to conviction at trial.

3.3 Classified Documents Case (Dismissed)

United States v. Donald J. Trump, Walt Nauta, Carlos De Oliveira

Court: U.S. District Court, Southern District of Florida

Judge: Aileen Cannon

Special Counsel: Jack Smith

Indictment Date: June 9, 2023

Charges: 40 criminal counts including:

- Willful Retention of National Defense Information (31 counts under Espionage Act, 18 U.S.C. § 793(e))
- Obstruction of Justice
- Conspiracy to Obstruct Justice
- False Statements

Prosecution Theory: Prosecutors alleged Trump unlawfully retained hundreds of classified documents after leaving office, stored them at his Mar-a-Lago estate in Florida, and took steps to obstruct government efforts to retrieve them, including allegedly instructing employees to move or hide documents.

Key Evidence:

- 15 boxes returned to National Archives in January 2022
- FBI search of Mar-a-Lago on August 8, 2022 recovered 100+ additional classified documents
- Audio recording of Trump discussing classified documents
- Testimony from employees regarding document handling

Disposition: **Dismissed** - Special Counsel Jack Smith dropped the prosecution on December 4, 2024, citing DOJ policy against prosecuting a sitting president. The case against co-defendants Nauta and De Oliveira remains pending.

3.4 Georgia Election Interference Case (Dismissed)

State of Georgia v. Donald J. Trump, et al.

Court: Fulton County Superior Court

Judge: Scott McAfee

District Attorney: Fani Willis (disqualified)

Indictment Date: August 14, 2023

Charges: Violations of Georgia's RICO (Racketeer Influenced and Corrupt Organizations) Act and 15 other Georgia statutes, including:

- Violation of Georgia RICO Act (O.C.G.A. § 16-14-4)
- Solicitation of Violation of Oath by a Public Officer
- Conspiracy to Commit Impersonation of a Public Officer
- Conspiracy to Commit Forgery
- Conspiracy to Commit Election Fraud

Prosecution Theory: Prosecutors alleged a "criminal organization" engaged in a wide-ranging conspiracy to overturn Georgia's 2020 presidential election results, including the famous phone call where Trump asked Secretary of State Brad Raffensperger to "find 11,780 votes."

Key Developments:

- 19 defendants indicted, including Trump and 18 allies
- Four defendants pleaded guilty and agreed to testify
- DA Fani Willis disqualified in 2024 due to romantic relationship with special prosecutor Nathan Wade
- Case transferred to Prosecuting Attorneys' Council of Georgia

Disposition: Dismissed - On November 26, 2025, the case was dismissed after prosecutor Peter Skandalakis determined that continuing prosecution "would not serve the interests of justice" and that federal venue was more appropriate.

4. Civil Litigation

4.1 E. Jean Carroll Defamation Cases

Carroll v. Trump (I and II)

Court: U.S. District Court, Southern District of New York

Judge: Lewis Kaplan

First Verdict: May 9, 2023

Second Verdict: January 26, 2024

Case I (2023): Carroll sued Trump for sexual assault and defamation. The jury found Trump liable for sexual abuse and defamation, awarding \$5 million in damages. The jury did not find Trump liable for rape as defined under New York law.

Case II (2024): Separate defamation action for statements Trump made while president in 2019. The jury awarded:

- \$18.3 million in compensatory damages
- \$65 million in punitive damages
- **Total: \$83.3 million**

Current Status: Judgment Affirmed - On September 8, 2025, the Second Circuit Court of Appeals upheld the \$83.3 million judgment, finding the damages "fair and reasonable" given Trump's "extraordinary and unprecedented" attacks on Carroll.

4.2 New York Civil Fraud Case

New York v. Trump, et al.

Court: New York Supreme Court

Judge: Arthur Engoron (trial); Appellate Division, First Department (appeal)

Filed: September 2022

Claims: Attorney General Letitia James alleged Trump, his adult children, and the Trump Organization engaged in years of fraud by inflating asset values on financial statements provided to banks and insurers.

Key Allegations:

- Inflated valuations of Trump Tower, Mar-a-Lago, golf courses, and other properties
- Misrepresentation of Trump's net worth by billions of dollars
- Deceptive practices to obtain favorable loan terms and insurance rates

Trial Court Ruling (February 2024):

- Judge Engoron found defendants liable for fraud
- Ordered payment of \$354.9 million plus interest (total exceeding \$464 million)
- Imposed 3-year ban on Trump doing business in New York
- Banned Trump Jr. and Eric Trump from corporate leadership for 2 years

Appeal Ruling (August 2025): The Appellate Division vacated the monetary penalty, finding it violated the Eighth Amendment's prohibition on excessive fines. However, the court upheld the liability finding and injunctive relief (business restrictions).

Current Status: **Under Further Appeal** - Attorney General James appealed to New York's highest court; Trump also appealed the remaining penalties.

4.3 Trump University Settlement

Low v. Trump University, LLC; Cohen v. Trump; New York v. Trump Entrepreneur Initiative

Court: U.S. District Court, Southern District of California

Judge: Gonzalo Curiel

Settlement Approved: April 10, 2018

Claims: Students alleged Trump University (a for-profit real estate seminar series, not an accredited university) defrauded them through misleading marketing and failed to deliver promised education.

Settlement Terms:

- \$25 million settlement finalized in 2018
- Trump admitted no wrongdoing
- Compensation for approximately 6,000 former students
- Settlement covered two class actions and New York Attorney General lawsuit

Note: During the 2016 campaign, Trump stated he "never" settles lawsuits and would not settle the Trump University case, calling it an "easy case to win." Settlement negotiations began days after the election.

4.4 Trump Foundation Dissolution

New York v. Donald J. Trump Foundation, et al.

Court: New York Supreme Court

Judge: Saliann Scarpulla

Filed: June 2018

Claims: The New York Attorney General alleged the Donald J. Trump Foundation engaged in:

- Breach of fiduciary duty and waste
- Improper administration of charitable assets
- Wrongful related-party transactions
- Self-dealing and campaign finance violations

Key Allegations:

- Foundation funds used for Trump's personal and business benefit
- \$10,000 portrait of Trump purchased with foundation funds
- Foundation used to settle legal claims against Trump's businesses
- Coordination with 2016 presidential campaign

Resolution: The foundation was dissolved under judicial supervision in December 2018. Remaining assets were distributed to approved charitable organizations under court oversight.

5. Legal Framework and Statutory References

5.1 Federal Criminal Statutes

Statute	Title	Maximum Penalty
18 U.S.C. § 371	Conspiracy to Defraud the United States	5 years imprisonment

5. Legal Framework and Statutory References

18 U.S.C. § 1512(c)	Obstruction of Official Proceeding	20 years imprisonment
18 U.S.C. § 1512(k)	Conspiracy to Obstruct Official Proceeding	20 years imprisonment
18 U.S.C. § 241	Conspiracy Against Rights	10 years imprisonment
18 U.S.C. § 793(e)	Unauthorized Retention of National Defense Information	10 years imprisonment
18 U.S.C. § 1001	False Statements	5 years imprisonment

5.2 New York State Criminal Statutes

Statute	Title	Classification
N.Y. Penal Law § 175.10	Falsifying Business Records in the First Degree	Class E Felony
N.Y. Penal Law § 175.05	Falsifying Business Records in the Second Degree	Class A Misdemeanor

5.3 Georgia Criminal Statutes

Statute	Title	Penalty Range
O.C.G.A. § 16-14-4	RICO Violation	5-20 years imprisonment
O.C.G.A. § 16-10-1	Impersonation of Public Officer	1-10 years imprisonment
O.C.G.A. § 16-9-1	Forgery	1-15 years imprisonment

5.4 Constitutional Provisions

Fifth Amendment (Double Jeopardy): "No person shall... be subject for the same offence to be twice put in jeopardy of life or limb."

Sixth Amendment (Right to Counsel and Speedy Trial): "In all criminal prosecutions, the accused shall enjoy the right to a speedy and public trial... and to have the Assistance of Counsel for his defence."

Eighth Amendment (Excessive Fines): "Excessive bail shall not be required, nor excessive fines imposed, nor cruel and unusual punishments inflicted."

Presidential Immunity (Trump v. United States, 2024): The Supreme Court held that former presidents have "absolute immunity" for actions within their "conclusive and preclusive constitutional authority," "presumptive immunity" for official acts, and no immunity for unofficial acts.

6. Chronology of Proceedings

Date		Event		Significance
June 2016		Trump University settlement		Post-election reversal of "never settle" position
November 2016		Trump University \$25M settlement finalized		Resolution of major civil fraud allegations
December 2018		Trump Foundation judicial dissolution		Charitable organization shut down by court order
March 2023	30,	Manhattan DA indictment (34 counts)		First criminal indictment of former U.S. president
June 9, 2023		Classified documents indictment (40 counts)		Federal charges under Espionage Act
August 2023	1,	Federal election interference indictment (4 counts)		Charges related to January 6 and 2020 election

6. Chronology of Proceedings

August 14, 2023	Georgia RICO indictment (19 defendants)	State charges including racketeering
May 9, 2023	Carroll I verdict (\$5M)	First civil verdict finding Trump liable for sexual abuse
May 30, 2024	Manhattan jury verdict (guilty on all 34 counts)	First criminal conviction of former U.S. president
January 26, 2024	Carroll II verdict (\$83.3M)	Largest civil judgment against Trump
February 2024	New York civil fraud judgment (\$464M)	Business restrictions imposed
July 1, 2024	Supreme Court immunity decision	Established presidential immunity framework
July 15, 2024	Judge Cannon dismisses documents case	Case dismissed based on special counsel appointment
November 5, 2024	Trump elected 47th President	Triggered DOJ policy on sitting presidents
November 25, 2024	Judge Chutkan dismisses election case	Case dismissed per DOJ policy
January 10, 2025	Manhattan sentencing (unconditional discharge)	No penalty imposed for 34 felony convictions
August 2025	NY civil fraud penalty vacated on appeal	\$464M fine struck down as excessive
September 2025	Carroll judgment affirmed by Second Circuit	\$83.3M defamation award upheld
November 2025	Georgia case dismissed	Final criminal case dismissed

7. Sources and References

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